

Current:
Atlanta, GA

Kevin D. Russell
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Hometown:
Lima, OH

EDUCATION

Emory University, Atlanta, GA, USA

Doctor of Philosophy in Political Science, expected May 2027

Master of Arts in Political Science, 2024

Dissertation Title: *A Poor Race in a Land of Dollars: Black Donors to Electoral Campaigns*

Doctoral Dissertation Committee: Dr. Kiela Crabtree, Dr. Bernard Fraga, Dr. Andra Gillespie (Chair), Dr. Zachary Peskowitz

Northwestern University, Evanston, IL, USA

Bachelor of Arts, June 2017

Major: Political Science; Minor: African American Studies

Political Science Department Certificate of Quantitative Achievement

RESEARCH INTEREST

Political Behavior, Financial Contributions, Racial and Ethnic Politics, Elections, Causal Inference, Mixed Methods Research

WORKING PAPERS

Russell, Kevin D., “From Protest to Pocketbooks: Black Donors to Electoral Campaigns”

Russell, Kevin D., “Mobilization of Black Donors by Black Candidates”

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming languages: R, Stata;

Quantitative research methods: survey analysis, voting data analysis, donation data analysis, survey administration;

Qualitative research methods: guided interviews, focus groups, ethnography, archival research

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “Mobilization of Black Donors by Black Candidates,” 2026 Annual Meeting of the National Conference of Black Political Scientists, College Park, MD

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “From Protest to Pocketbooks: Black Donors to Electoral Campaigns,” 2025 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Vancouver, BC

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “From Protest to Pocketbooks: Black Donors to Electoral Campaigns,” 2025 Annual Meeting of the National Conference of Black Political Scientists, New Orleans, LA

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “From Protest to Pocketbooks: Political Donations by Racial Identity and Motivations for Black Giving,” 2024 Annual Meeting of the National Conference of Black Political Scientists, Los Angeles, CA

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “Black Candidate Appeals and Donations by Individuals,” 2024 Politics of Race, Immigration, and Ethnicity Consortium, Charlotte, NC

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “Relative Contributions and Determinants of Black Campaign Donations,” 2023 Annual Meeting of the National Conference of Black Political Scientists, Atlanta, GA

Russell, Kevin D., (nd) “Relative Contributions and Determinants of Black Campaign Donations,” 2023 Atlanta Symposium of Political Science, Atlanta, GA

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Dissertation research, Department of Political Science, Emory University 08/2022-Present
Formulate a research agenda, synthesize relevant literature, and build a novel theory.
Perform quantitative analysis involving federal donation data, state-level voter history records, and national surveys.
Created Internal Review Board-approved interview guide and collected and analyzed original interview data from campaign finance officials using qualitative research methods.

Research Assistant, Department of Political Science, Emory University 08/2021-12/2022
Collected data on electoral outcomes and funds raised. Gathered and reviewed literature on subjects such as issue voting, education policy, and racial messaging. Provided transcriptions and copy-editing.

Research Assistant, Department of Political Science, Northwestern University 06/2015-06/2017
Performed content analysis on multiple decades of editorial data based on a specific coding scheme and reporting statistical trends in the data to get a sense of U.S. presidential performance and public reaction to presidents’ actions with the goal of producing a ranking of modern American presidents.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT IN PUBLICATIONS

Alvin B. Tillery Jr. and Hanes Walton Jr. “Presidential Greatness in the Black Press: Ranking the Modern Presidents on Civil Rights Policy and Race Relations, 1900–2016.” *Politics, Groups, and Identities*, vol. 5, no. 1, 2017, pp. 71-88.

HONORS & AWARDS

DFP Travel Grant , American Political Science Association	July 2026
Travel Grant , National Conference of Black Political Scientists	March 2026
Travel Grant , American Political Science Association	September 2025
DFP Travel Grant , American Political Science Association	September 2025
Inductee , Bouchet Graduate Honor Society	April 2025
Travel Grant , National Conference of Black Political Scientists	March 2025
Diversity Fellowship Program , American Political Science Association	Spring 2023
Centennial Scholar Fellowship , Emory University	08/2021-Present
Northwestern Scholarship , Northwestern University	09/2013-06/2017
Dean’s List , Northwestern University	01/2016-06/2017
Kakehashi Project , Japan Ministry of Foreign Affairs/Intl Cooperation Center	March 2017
Summer Internship Grant Program , Northwestern University	06/2016-09/2016
Posner Fellowship , Northwestern University	06/2015-09/2015

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Professional Development , Emory University	05-07/2025; 06-07/2026
Curated content for and led in-person sessions for undergraduate students seeking to gain research experience and to matriculate into graduate school.	
Guest Lecturer, Race and Ethnicity Politics in the U.S. , Emory University	November 2025
Discussed the connection between descriptive representation, substantive representation, and candidate evaluations.	
Facilitated group writing activity.	
Guest Lecturer, U.S. National Politics , Emory University	October 2025

Lectured on congress and the courts for students with little-to-no assumed knowledge.

Grader, Race and Ethnicity Politics in the U.S., Emory University 08/2025-12/2025

Co-Instructor, U.S. National Politics, Emory University 01/2025-05/2025

Lectured on parties, party identification, congress, participation, elections, among other topics
Graded midterm exam and weekly writing assignments.

Teaching Assistant, Research Design and Methods, Emory University 01/2024-05/2024

Led weekly discussion sections and gave personalized feedback to students on research designs.

Grader, U.S. National Politics, Emory University 01/2023-05/2023

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Fellow, Laney Graduate School Advancing Excellence through Recruitment and Opportunities, Emory University 08/2025-Present

Facilitated team-building activities, discussed graduate school experiences, and presented research poster during two-day event for prospective graduate students.

Spoke with undergraduate students during graduate school fairs and fostered inclusive environment during on-campus events.

Ambassador, Jones Program in Ethics, Emory University August 2025

Led virtual session on the importance of mentorship in graduate education for newest cohort of graduate students

Junior Fellow, Laney Graduate School Emory Diversifying Graduate Education, Emory University 08/2024-07/2025

Presented research poster for and directed prospective students to sessions across campus.

Spoke with undergraduate students during graduate school fairs and fostered inclusive environment during on-campus events.

Recruitment, Political Science Department, Emory University 2022-2024

Attended Ralph Bunche Summer Institute as student recruiter.

Spoke to admitted students about their enrollment decision.

Advisor to the Office of the Provost, Emory University 01/2023-02/2023

Consulted during the interview process for the position of Director of Truth, Healing, and Transformation.

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Executive Team Member, Emory Graduate Student Parent Association, 01/2024-Present

Liaison between the group and the bargaining committee to ensure the inclusion of parents' concerns in policies and funding opportunities.
Plan and attend family-friendly events in the Atlanta area.

Mentor, Evanston Scholars, *Evanston Township High School* 09/2019-06/2025
Supported a high school junior through from college application through college graduation. Evanston Scholars seeks to improve college access and success for a diverse group of ambitious students who are traditionally first-generation college entrants, students from low-income families, and students of color.

Interviewer, Alumni Admission Council, *Northwestern University* 08/2019-04/2024
Met with prospective students to supplement application materials with insights from one-on-one conversations.

Internal Co-Chair, Young Professionals Board, *John Howard Association* 04/2019-11/2020
Oversaw recruitment efforts and doubled board membership.
The John Howard Association is Illinois' only independent citizen correctional oversight organization.

Moderator, Sustained Dialogue, *Northwestern University* 02/2016-06/2017
Facilitated open and respectful group dialogues among students on personal, campus-wide, and national issues after completing 18 hours of training.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Business Development Representative, Infutor Data Solutions, *Chicago, IL* 04/2020-07/2021
Profile strategic accounts, identify key players, research and obtain business requirements, and present solutions to begin sales cycle for companies looking to improve customer acquisition, growth, and experience through consumer data. Set meetings for account executives with companies that fit the ideal client profile through tactful communication with external executives.

Annual Performance Review: "Kevin demonstrates all of the core values to make him a long-term, high growth at Infutor. His focus on creativity and skill development will be key to insuring his increasing success." 12/2020

Senior Site Development Specialist, SAC Wireless, *Chicago, IL* 11/2017-03/2020
Directed and managed project development processes to facilitate the installation of new cellular equipment for Sprint at its rented telecommunication sites. Charged with obtaining land owner approval, jurisdictional zoning approval and building permit, and final client sign-off on hundreds of sites.

Annual Performance Review: "Extraordinary Impact" 01/2020

Intern, Common Cause Illinois, *Chicago, IL* 09/2016-12/2016

Organized poll-watching volunteers at over 100 polling places for the 2016 Presidential election and composed hundreds of tweets and dozens of Facebook posts for CCIL social media efforts. Compelled two aldermen to commit votes for the Fair Elections Ordinance, which creates a small-donor public-financing system for Chicago elected officials.

Special Projects Intern, *U.S. Department of Commerce, Advocacy Center, Washington D.C.*

06/2016-09/2016

Collaborated with the Executive Director to support the goal of helping U.S. companies to win foreign government contracts across the globe. Created ten dashboards to summarize Advocacy Center data, including dollars raised and clients served.

Administrative Assistant, NU Department of Political Science, *Evanston, IL* 09/2016-08/2017

Converted over 30 years of course syllabi into electronic files. Responded to phone calls and directed visitors.

Campus Ambassador, Monster Energy Drinks, *Evanston, IL*

09/2014-06/2017

Distributed energy drinks in collaboration with student organizations and university events. Communicated with superiors with documentation of efforts.

Customer Service Rep., Henry Crown Sports Pavilion, *Evanston, IL*

09/2013-08/2017

Provided fitness equipment to patrons together with other CSRs and observed use to ensure patron safety.